

School of Health & Social Sciences

CPC 514: Research Methods and Statistics
VANWDY 17 B

3 Credits
Effective Date (07/02/2026)
Course Dates: 7/1- 9/24, 2026

Faculty & Contact Information

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Access to the Internet is required.
All written assignments must be in Microsoft-Word-compatible formats.
See the library's APA Style Guide tutorial for a list of APA resources.

Vision, Mission, and Values

The vision of CityU's Master of Counselling Program is to educate skilled, diverse, socially just psychological practitioners. Our mission is to prepare culturally competent clinicians to work effectively with individuals through our practitioner-scholar-advocate model. This brings real-world experience into the classroom and emphasizes the core principles of reconciliation, diversity, equity, and inclusion. Our core program values are reconciliation, diversity, advocacy, flexibility, connection, and healing.

Territorial Acknowledgement & Statement of Inclusion

We acknowledge that our Vancouver campus is located on the unceded and traditional territories of the xʷməθkʷəy̓əm (Musqueam), skwxwú7mesh (Squamish), and səliłwətał (Tsleil-Waututh) Coast Salish peoples.

CityU honours human diversity in all its forms and is committed to the principle of universal human dignity. We further acknowledge that our learning community is greatly enriched through the voices and perspectives of staff, faculty, and students from all intersections of society including LGBTQ+, BIPOC and diversely-abled communities.

Course Description

This course introduces students to research in the social sciences and provides them with the skills to critically review human wellness literature. Both qualitative and quantitative methodologies will be explored (e.g., autoethnography, indigenous methodologies, experimental design etc.). Proposals from this course may be further developed for later use in thesis and capstone research projects.

Consideration of Social Justice Issues

City University in Canada is committed to social justice, access, and inclusion. Throughout their studies in the Master of Counselling Program, students are invited to reflect on a range of social justice questions as follows:

- What are the implications of the historical exploitation of vulnerable populations in scientific research?
- How can researchers ensure their work is respectful of non-dominant cultural norms?
- What does ethical, anti-oppressive research look like in practice?

Course Resources

Creswell, J.W., & Creswell, J. D. (2022). *Research Design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches* (6th ed). California: Sage. (ISBN: 978-1071817940). **Required.**

Program Outcomes

The content of this course aligns with the following Program Outcomes:

PO 6 Research: Locate and critically evaluate research related to core areas of Counselling practice.

- 6.1 *Critical Analysis*: Find, evaluate, and critically analyze existing and emergent research in the field of counselling.
- 6.2 *Data Analysis*: Analyze quantitative and qualitative data to draw valid and relevant conclusions.
- 6.3 *Research Topic*: Develop a focused research topic and questions that advances thinking in the field of counselling.
- 6.4 *Research Design*: Design a research study that is ethical, valid, and reliable.

Grading Scale

The grades earned for the course will be calculated using City University of Seattle's decimal grading system, found in the current University Catalog.

Scale	100.00 – 92.00	91.99-85.00	84.99 – 75.00	74.99 – 0.00
Decimal Grade Equivalent	4.0 – 3.7	3.6 – 3.0	2.9 – 2.0	1.9 - 0.0
	Exceeds Standard	At Standard	Approaching Standard	Below Standard

Grading rubrics with details on how each assignment will be graded are located under Assignments and/or in My Grades in the online course menu. Students should review the rubric for each assignment prior to completing their work in order to understand how it will be assessed.

Course Assignments and Grading

The grades earned for the course will be derived using CityU's decimal grading system, based on the following:

Overview of Required Assignments	% of Final Grade
Research Article Analysis-Group Presentation (1)	20%
Peer Review Discussion Board Activity-Instructor Determined Assignment (2)	20%
Peer-Review Group Report (3)	10%
Research Study Design-Individual Paper (4)	40%
Attendance / Participation (5)	10%
Total	100%

Course Assignment Details

Research Article Analysis-Group Presentation (assignment 1)

In small groups (assigned randomly by the system), students will collaborate on 45–60-minute **presentation** analyzing an instructor-approved article. Presentation **topics** and preferred presentation **dates** must be **submitted to the instructor by email** for approval **on a first-come, first-served basis**.

Beginning in **Week 4** and continuing through **Week 8**, each group will **present live in each class** according to the order in which requests are received. **The deadline to submit your article and preferred presentation day is before the second session Wednesday, July 8, 11:59 pm. If no email is received from a group by the deadline**, the instructor will assign that group to any remaining unselected date, which may include **July 23, the first day of presentations**.

The email must include all group members' emails, names, the group number (and presenting order), the PDF of selected article, and the preferred presentation date.

Each group will review and critically analyze a peer-reviewed research article that may report on either a quantitative or qualitative study. Using methodology-specific criteria, students will examine and discuss the following aspects of the study:

1) the research question and hypothesis; 2) the study design; 3) data analysis; 4) conclusions; 5) clinical applications; and 6) ethics issues.

Students will consider the following questions in their analysis: 1) Is the design appropriate for the research question or hypothesis? 2) Are the population and sampling techniques appropriate? 3) Were issues of reliability and validity addressed, including the adequacy of the controls used? 4) are the researcher's conclusions robustly supported by the data? 5) what alternative interpretations can be drawn from the data?

Students are encouraged to explore a range of presentation modalities including Powerpoint slides, spoken word poetry, dramatic skits, animation, monologues, videos, storytelling, music, dance, improv, collage, scrapbooking, story boarding, sculpture, quilting, papier-mâché, mandalas, painting, drawing, puppetry etc.

Group members will have to meet with their groups online to plan their presentation including scenario, characters, script, etc.

After presenting, each group is required to upload its slides in **PPT format** to ensure visibility of **presenter notes** (a brief summary of what you intend to say for each specific slide) to **the discussion forum** for other groups to review **by midnight on the day of their presentations**, and **also submit** the same file **in the assignment submission area** for the instructor to grade.

Grading Criteria	Grade Points
Organization and Coherence	10 Points
Evidence and Support	20 Points

Critical Analysis	20 Points
Professional Ethics	20 Points
Cultural Competence	20 Points
Quality of Presentation	10 Points
Total	100 Points

Peer Review Discussion Board Activity-Instructor Determined Assignment (assignment 2)

Students will complete an instructor-determined assignment that integrates their understanding of course concepts through critical reflection and application to counseling settings.

The purpose of this assignment is to engage students in providing constructive peer feedback as a group on the discussion board following each presentation.

On weeks when they are not presenting, students will work within their presentation groups to provide feedback on another group's presentation. This feedback should address the following:

1. What did we appreciate about the group's work?
2. What did we find challenging about it?
3. What recommendations do we have for improvement?

Each week, only the designated representative from each group will submit a comprehensive feedback post in the discussion area (visible to all groups) and a submission assignment in the submission area (for the instructor) by **Monday at 11:59 PM**.

This feedback should evaluate both:

- CONTENT (what was presented)
- CONTEXT (how it was delivered)

In response, a designated representative from the presenting group will have the opportunity to reply to the feedback (**optional**) by **Wednesday at 11:59 PM**.

By the end of the course, each group must have **four Word Document files (no PDFs)** submissions of feedback responses in the designated area **as well as one integrated Word Document file**, clearly naming each file (e.g., *Group 1's Feedback on Group 2's Presentation*).

For further guidance on giving and receiving feedback, students are encouraged to review the provided resource:

The Importance of Presentation Feedback

<https://presentationgeeks.com/blog/importance-of-presentation-feedback/>

Grading Criteria	Grade Points
Feedback on the Strength Areas of the Presentation Content	25 Points

Feedback on the Improvement Areas of the Presentation Content	25 Points
Feedback on the Strength Areas of the Presentation Context	25 Points
Feedback on the Improvement Areas of the Presentation Context	25 Points
Total	100 Points

Peer Review Group Report (assignment 3)

For this assignment, each group must submit a **15-minute video and one page summary** as a recipient of feedback, reflecting on their learning from the process.

Within their presentation group, students will collaboratively compile insights on appreciation, challenges, and changes based on the feedback received. The video should include specific examples of the feedback, interpretations of its significance, and reflections on how it has shaped their understanding.

The goal of the video is to show your team having a real discussion about the peer feedback you received. To make this clear, **everyone needs to be on screen together** in a single recording (like a Zoom or Teams meeting recording).

Videos where everyone is separate or edited together from individual clips won't meet the goal of the assignment and will unfortunately lose marks.

The video **and one page summary**, due no later than **Sunday, Sep. 13, 2026, at 11:59 PM**, must address the following questions:

1. What have we learned from the received feedback?
2. How do we feel about what we've learned?
3. What are our thoughts regarding what we've learned?
4. What is our plan for improvement based on the received feedback?

To ensure meaningful reflection, group members must convene weekly, either online or in person, to discuss their responses and record their reflections.

Grading Criteria	Grade Points
Organization and Coherence	10 Points
Evidence and Support	20 Points
Analysis and use of Course Concepts	20 Points
Evaluating Information	20 Points
Self-reflection	30 Points
Total	100 Points

Research Study Design (assignment 4)

In consultation with their instructor, students will design a research study using a topic that could potentially serve as a capstone project. The paper will include: 1) a research question; 2) the significance and context of the question; 3) the conceptual framework of the study; 4) relevant areas of literature; 5) eight to ten scholarly sources; 6) research variables; 7) the study methodology; 8) the data collection procedure; and 9) the method of analysis.

This paper will include an ethics proposal that could be submitted to the university's Institutional Review Board (IRB). Instructors will provide sample proposals and forms as appropriate.

This paper, scheduled for submission on **Sunday, Sep. 6, 2026**, at 11:59 pm must be 10 - 12 pages, double-spaced, using a minimum of 8 - 10 peer-reviewed sources from the past 5 years. APA formatting and citations are mandatory as the failure to cite sources appropriately constitutes plagiarism.

Grading Criteria	Grade Points
Organization and Coherence	10 Points
Evidence and Support	20 Points
Analysis and use of Course Concepts	20 Points
Professional Ethics	20 Points
Research Topic	20 Points
APA	10 Points
Total	100 Points

Attendance / Participation (assignment 5)

As a counseling program, active attendance and participation are essential to developing the skills required in the field. Meaningful interaction with your peers is necessary to establish the rapport and trust inherent in counseling. To support this, attendance in all classes is required, as these sessions are crucial components of your learning. Absences will only be excused in cases of illness or emergency, and a written notification must be submitted to the instructor. Documentation, such as a doctor's note, may be requested.

Participation grades are based on engagement in class activities, including contributing to discussions, actively listening, allowing space for others to speak, and demonstrating involvement in practice and demo sessions. Respect for the group process and constructive participation are key expectations.

At the beginning of each class, students must contribute to group activities designed around thought-provoking discussion questions and continue to engage throughout the session. At the end of each class, students are expected to participate in discussions on key takeaways and reflections on their learning.

Grading Criteria	Grade Points
Attendance	50 Points
Participation	50 Points
Total	100 Points

Course Policies

Late Assignments

Graduate students are expected to submit all assignments by the due dates stated in the syllabus. A late assignment is one that is submitted after the due date and time or after any extension has expired.

If circumstances prevent a student from meeting the due date, students should contact the instructor and request an extension at least 48 hours prior to the date the assignment is due. Emergency situations will be considered on a case-by-case basis. Being busy, pressured with outside work, or having competing academic commitments are not usually considered valid reasons to receive extensions.

A student who receives an extension in advance of the due date and abides by the agreement with the instructor is not subject to late penalties. The guideline for late penalties is a deduction of one point per day from the overall grade for the first 10 days and 5 points per day after 10 days. Instructors may vary these guidelines in response to the specific conditions and requirements of each course. In the absence of an alternative announced by the Instructor the default policy is the general guideline cited above. Assignments may be re-written only with the express consent of the Instructor and under exceptional circumstances.

Participation

All MC courses encourage active engagement in discussion, dialogue, role plays and similar exercises in order to receive the maximum educational benefits. Participation includes constructive criticism and the negotiation of different perspectives and ideas. Recognizing that there are many forms of participation a range of forms and styles are welcomed. Active engagement means being attentive. Similarly, it is recognized that there are situations in which learning to hold one's counselor to not participate verbally are valuable learning experiences.

Consistent attendance and a willingness to be actively involved in classroom discussions, small group activities, and at times classroom presentations or role plays assists in creating a vibrant learning community.

Many MC courses include a participation component and, in some cases, assignments specify that participation will be graded. In such cases the criteria for participation will be made known along with the requirements for grade achievement.

Professional Writing

Assignments require error-free writing that uses standard English conventions and logical flow of organization to address topics clearly, completely, and concisely. CityU requires the use of APA style.

University Policies

Students are responsible for understanding and adhering to all of CityU's academic policies. The most current versions of these policies can be found in the University Catalog that is linked from the CityU Web site.

Non-Discrimination & Prohibition of Sexual Harassment

City University of Seattle, its staff and its faculty are deeply committed to supporting our students. We value equity, diversity, and inclusion as a way of life as well as for the educational opportunities it provides. CityU will not tolerate any form of discrimination based on race, color, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender identification, socioeconomic status, or religious values. Any student who has experienced discrimination based on the above criteria is encouraged to report this to the University. Students may report an experience of discrimination to their course instructor. If they do not feel safe reporting to their instructor, students may report an experience of discrimination directly to the university Provost or the Vice President of Student Affairs.

CityU adheres to all federal, state, and local civil rights laws prohibiting discrimination in employment and education. The University is committed to ensuring that the education environment is bounded by standards of mutual respect and safety and is free from discriminatory practices.

In the U.S., the University is required by Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 to ensure that all of its education programs and activities do not discriminate on the basis of sex/gender. Sex include sex, sex stereotypes, gender identity, gender expression, sexual orientation, and pregnancy or parenting status. Sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating and domestic violence, and stalking are forms of sex discrimination, which are prohibited under Title IX and by CityU policy. CityU also prohibits retaliation against any person opposing discrimination or participating in any discrimination investigation or complaint process internal or external to the institution. Questions regarding Title IX, including its application and/or concerns about noncompliance, should be directed to the Title IX Coordinator. For more information visit Title IX Policy and Contact Information.

In Canada, in compliance with the British Columbia Human Rights Code, the Alberta Human Rights Act, WorksafeBC, and the Workers' Compensation Board of Alberta, the University believes that its environment should at all times be supportive and respectful of the dignity and self-esteem of individuals. Discrimination, harassment and bullying conduct, whether through person-to-person behaviour or via electronic communications such as email or social media is not acceptable and will not be tolerated. As an educational institution, it is our responsibility to cultivate an environment of excellence, equity, mutual respect and to recognize the value and potential of every individual. The University will take all necessary steps to meet or exceed the requirements of the law to prevent discrimination, harassment and bullying. Information on the prevention of discrimination, harassment and bullying can be found at Canada's Respectful Workplace Policy.

Religious Accommodations

CityU has a policy for accommodation of student absences or significant hardship due to reasons of faith or conscience, or for organized religious activities. The University's policy, including more information about how to request an accommodation, is available in the University Catalog and on the my.cityu.edu student portal. Accommodations must be requested by the 20% mark of this course (e.g. day 14 of a ten-week course, day 7 of a 5-week course) using the Religious Accommodations Request Form found on the student dashboard in the my.cityu.edu student portal.

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity in students requires the pursuit of scholarly activity that is free from fraud, deception and unauthorized collaboration with other individuals. Students are responsible for

understanding CityU's policy on academic integrity and adhering to its standards in meeting all course requirements. A complete copy of this policy can be found in the University Catalog under *Student Rights and Responsibilities* on the page titled *Academic Integrity Policy*.

AI Use Policy ("Traffic-Light" Approach): Green: AI use is fully permitted (e.g., brainstorming ideas or generating outlines). Yellow: Limited AI use is allowed for grammar and spell-checking only. AI must not replace your own content. If you use AI for this purpose, you must acknowledge it. Red: AI use is prohibited for creating content, as this constitutes academic dishonesty.

Attendance

Students taking courses in any format at the University are expected to be diligent in their studies and attend class regularly. Regular class attendance/contact is important in achieving learning outcomes in the course and correlates in many cases with participation. As such it may be a valid consideration in determining the final grade. At the beginning of each course, the instructor will inform students of the relevance of class attendance/contact to the final grade.

Attendance in this class is vital to learning the required course material and demonstrates professionalism and respect for fellow students and the instructor. All students are required to attend every class for the full duration of the class. Arriving late or leaving early will constitute an unexcused absence. It is expected that students who will not be attending or who will be arriving late notify the instructor before class starts.

Excused absences are limited to ILLNESS OR EMERGENCY. Absences related to illness may require verification from a medical doctor. All other absences will be considered unexcused.

In the event of inclement weather, students will be notified by a CityU representative and / or faculty of site closures. As student and faculty safety is a priority, students who feel that driving conditions are unsafe will be permitted an excused absence without penalty. Students are responsible for notifying the instructor before class starts that they will not be attending class due to inclement weather.

Students with more than 2 unexcused absences will be directed to meet with the local Program Director to discuss continued participation in the course. 3% of students' overall course grade will be deducted for each unexcused absence.

A complete copy of CityU's policy can be found in the University Catalog under *Student Rights and Responsibilities* on the page titled *Attendance*.

Final Assignment Due Date

Final assignments for each class at CityU must be due on or before the final date of the course as indicated in the university's course information system. Due dates that extend beyond the final date of the course may negatively impact tuition funding for students.

Support Services

Disability Services Accommodations Statement

Students with a documented disability who wish to request academic accommodations are encouraged to contact Disability Support Services to discuss accommodation requests and eligibility requirements. Please contact Disability Support Services at disability@cityu.edu or 206.239.4571 or visit Academic Accommodation Services. Confidentiality will be observed in all

inquiries. Once approved, information about academic accommodations will be shared with course instructors.

Library Services

CityU librarians are available to help students find the resources and information they need to succeed in this course. Contact a CityU librarian through the Ask a Librarian Services, or access library resources and services online 24 hours a day, seven days a week.

Brainfuse Tutoring

All students receive free, unlimited tutoring through Brainfuse. To gain access, click on the **Help** button from within your Brightspace class and select the **Brainfuse** link. Resources include live tutoring, a Writing Lab, expert Q & A, and the ability to create flashcards, online quizzes/games, study groups, video notes, and record tutoring sessions.

Sensitive Content Notice

Because the counselling profession is designed to explore the inner life of individuals, certain content discussed in CityU's Master of Counselling courses may be emotionally activating for students. The university's goal is to empower students to practice active self-care throughout their time in the program. Active self-care is an ethical responsibility for those in self-regulating professions and assists clinicians in successfully meeting clients in spaces where emotionally sensitive content is present. Similarly, in the Master of Counselling program, an ethic of care for the self is a critical consideration.

Emotionally sensitive content involves a wide variety of topics including, but not limited to, abuse, assault, neglect, self-harm, identity, sexuality, appearance, misogyny, classism, racialized issues, colonization, religious practices, trauma, grieving, ageism, caregiving, and physical or mental health. Students are encouraged to carefully attend to their emotional wellbeing when reading, listening to, viewing, or participating in course activities involving sensitive content.

It is important to note that exploring sensitive content is an inherent part of the counselling profession. However, the complexity of human experience means students' personal histories may become activated to the point that effective learning is no longer feasible. In such cases, students are encouraged to prioritize balancing their emotional wellbeing with their professional growth. This may be done through timely self-reflection and communication with instructors and/or peers about the self-regulation strategies students will implement while engaging sensitive content.

As part of their professional growth, students are also encouraged to pursue personal counselling related to sensitive content explored in the program. Personal counselling deepens students' learning and provides insight into their future clients' experiences of the therapeutic process. Additional resources available to students include the Empower Me Program, Self-Care folders in Brightspace, and local campus wellness initiatives

Master of Counselling's Professional Code (2.0)

In addition to City University's general student code of conduct located in the Registrar's City U Calendar, counselling students are further expected to conduct themselves in a manner that is consistent with the core values of the profession they are entering. Students will be encouraged to adopt the following behaviours and are accountable to their peers, faculty, and CityU to sincerely undertake the development of these hallmarks of maturity:

1. Respect the dignity of classmates, faculty, and administrators without prejudice in all forms of behaviour and communication in matters of race, religion, skin colour, ethnicity, gender, orientation, physical presentation, age, ancestry or birthplace. This includes, but is not limited to, standing up against and/or reporting behaviours such as bullying, scapegoating, gossip, slander etc.
2. Maintain a positive approach to managing course-related, administrative, or relationship challenges in line with the core values of the profession. This includes, but is not limited to, directly approaching specific individuals regarding concerns of note and attempting to collaborate and independently problem-solve prior to involving faculty or administrators in the matter. Students who feel unable to independently resolve the issue should seek the support of cohort representatives, faculty, or staff.
3. Demonstrate exemplary personal conduct consistent with the values of the profession including integrity, accountability, reflexivity, generosity, compassion, inclusiveness, honesty, courage, maturity, thoughtfulness, good judgment, patience, and fairness. Demonstrate a commitment to modelling the standards and ethics of the counselling profession in all aspects of personal conduct in both the university and community at large.
4. Access City University's campuses or resources ONLY with approval from an authorized representative of the university.
5. Recognize that students with formal academic accommodations are expected to meet the same academic standards as their peers with the help of additional supports and reasonable, penalty free extensions.
6. Recognize that consistent face-to-face and online class attendance is a basic, non-negotiable requirement of the program and that the program's attendance policies will be enforced without exception. Students who are absent for any reason are required to make up all instructional hours and assignments at the discretion of the instructor.
7. Ensure that all requests for assignment extensions (with and without accommodations) are submitted to faculty a minimum of 48 hours in advance of the assignment due date. Extensions may not be granted after assignment due dates have passed.
8. Respect and behave in accordance with the appropriate professional boundaries inherent in faculty, administrative, and evaluative roles.
9. As an ambassador for the City University program, conduct themselves in a manner that strengthens the reputation of the profession, one's peers, and the program.
10. Actively develop and practice the core counselling skills of attunement, presence, and empathy in all program-related interpersonal interactions.
11. Respond to feedback from faculty and administrators in ways that facilitate personal growth, preserve our collaborative learning environment, and reflect the standards of the counselling profession.
12. Balance enthusiastic contributions to classroom discussion with ensuring there is sufficient space for all voices to be heard. This involves actively staying aware of the dynamics of class discussions and actively encouraging everyone's participation.
13. Commit to active course participation that contributes to one's own and others learning.
14. Embrace both positive and challenging academic learning opportunities and consider how these experiences can be applied in the service of personal and professional growth.